



INSTRUCTIONAL AREA

Customer Relations

AUTOMOTIVE SERVICES MARKETING SERIES EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "The event will be presented to you through your reading of the 21st Century Skills, Performance Indicators and Case Study Situation. You will have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. You may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to make your presentation to the judge (you may have more than one judge)."
- "You will be evaluated on how well you meet the performance indicators of this event."
- "Turn in all of your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

21st CENTURY SKILLS

- Critical Thinking – Reason effectively and use systems thinking.
- Communication – Communicate clearly.
- Creativity and Innovation – Show evidence of creativity.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Demonstrate a customer service mindset.
2. Reinforce service orientation through communication.
3. Interpret business policies to customers/clients.
4. Handle customer/client complaints.
5. Explain the nature of positive customer relations.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of the customer relations manager at QUICK FIX AUTO CARE, a well-established automotive service center known for its affordable and timely services. A regular customer (judge) has come to the service center upset because of a recent price increase on oil change services. For the past two years, the customer (judge) has been paying \$50 for a full synthetic oil change, but the price has now gone up to \$75. The customer (judge) is considering taking their business to a nearby competitor that advertises cheaper prices.

Your task is to explain the reasons behind the price increase and offer potential solutions to retain the customer's loyalty. The price increase is due to rising costs of materials and labor, but you have the authority to offer several retention options:

- A one-time discount of \$10 on the next oil change
- A loyalty program where the customer (judge) can earn points for future services, such as free tire rotations or discounted brake services
- A bundled service package (oil change, tire rotation, and brake inspection) for \$100, saving the customer (judge) 20% on individual services

The customer (judge) is concerned about rising costs and feels that as a loyal customer, they deserve a more competitive rate. Your role is to address the customer's frustrations, explain the reasons for the price change, and offer a solution that ensures they continue using QUICK FIX AUTO CARE.

You will present your response to the customer (judge) in a role-play to take place in the customer service area of the service center. The customer (judge) will begin the role-play by expressing their dissatisfaction with the price increase. After you have presented information and answered the customer's (judge's) questions, the customer (judge) will conclude the role-play by thanking you for your assistance.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. How did you ensure that I (the customer) felt valued despite the higher cost?
2. If I (the customer) remain dissatisfied after your initial response, how would you follow up to ensure my long-term satisfaction?

Did the participant:		Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Demonstrate a customer service mindset?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
2.	Reinforce service orientation through communication?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
3.	Interpret business policies to customers/clients?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
4.	Handle customer/client complaints?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
5.	Explain the nature of positive customer relations?	0-1-2-3	4-5-6-7	8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
6.	Unique– Demonstrates original thinking, fresh perspectives, and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
7.	Practical– Actionable/viable in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
8.	Effective– Achieves relevant outcomes.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAREER COMPETENCIES						
9.	Critical Thinking– Thinks critically to understand and solve problems.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
10.	Communication– Communicates clearly, effectively, and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
11.	Decision-making– Considers the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSION						
12.	Overall impression– The degree to which the presentation leaves a lasting impression.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
TOTAL SCORE						